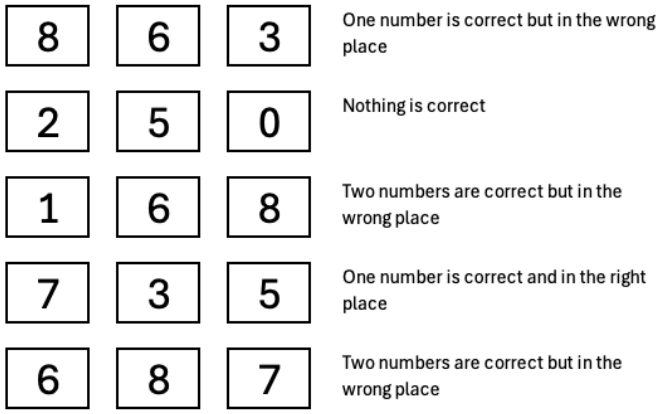
Decode DLE

The aim of the challenge here is to work out a three-digit number to obtain the flag, based on the clues provided :



We start by looking at all the different numbers we have: 0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8. We can immediately rule out 2, 5 and 0 because nothing is correct in the second row. That leaves us with 1, 3, 4, 6, 7, 8 .
Then, in the two rows where two numbers are correct but in the wrong place, we have either a 6 at the end – because in both rows it is either at the start or in the middle – and then the 8 must be at the start, because in both rows it is at the end and in the middle. Then we have the 7, which can be at the start or the end, and the 1 as well. In the line where a number is correctly placed and correct, the 3 goes back to the middle, the 5 no longer exists, and the 7 must be at the start or the end; so we have either _31 or _36. I tried 836 – the code was incorrect – but with 736 the code was correct in the flag input, so the flag is: deadface{736}